

Paper 5

The Closure Principle and Configuration Stability

Paper 5 of the Series

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ABSTRACT

Paper 4 fixed the two anchors of the universal ruler: the photon as sovereign zero and the electron-positron pair as the first resolved mark. This paper supplies the principle that explains why those anchors — and only those anchors — hold. The Closure Principle is the formal name of the resolution requirement the series has carried since Paper 2 and froze in Paper 4: a configuration is closed if and only if it is resolved, meaning its inner identity scan can lock onto a single, unambiguous core and its outer surface carries nothing unsettled. Stated mechanically, stability is not a substance, a binding force, or a probability; it is the success or failure of the identity scan. A pure baseline core (the photon's three O values) and a native triplet core (the electron's three X or the positron's three Y) are the only single-configuration cores the scan can lock, so States 9 and 1 are the only standalone stable configurations the twenty-seven-state ledger permits. Every other state holds its departure — conservation forbids spontaneous reversal — but holding is not stability: a stranded open state persists while searching, and the distinction between persisting and being stable is the distinction between a waypoint and a standard. The paper ranks all nine states by what their cores allow the identity scan to do, resolves the apparent anomaly of State 4's even surface over an unlockable core, extends the principle to composite junctions to state what bonds can close, and ends with the principle's falsifiable consequence: no standalone stable configuration without a lockable core may exist anywhere, at any scale. One verified counterexample breaks the principle and the ruler built on it.

1. Purpose: From Anchors to the Principle Behind Them

The bridge of terms, fixed first. This paper's title carries the name given in the series plan: the Closure Principle. Throughout, that name is defined exactly by the frozen vocabulary of Paper 4, Appendix B: a configuration *closes* if and only if it is *resolved* — its identity scan locks, its surface carries nothing unsettled, and it stands alone. "Closure" is the principle's formal name; "resolved" is the mechanical condition; they are one thing, and no second meaning of either word is used anywhere in this paper or this series.

Paper 4 established *that* the photon is the zero and *that* State 1 is the first resolved mark, and proved the counting theorem that puts the first mark three tilts from the photon. What Paper 4 did not do — by its own contract — is state the general principle from which those facts follow, the principle that decides stability for every configuration and every composite, at every rung of the structural hierarchy. That is this paper's single job.

The contract of this paper. Precision about what is proven, what is adopted, and what is risked, so the principle cannot be mistaken for a circle. The Closure Principle has three parts of different logical kinds. The first is an *operational definition*, adopted openly in the manner of Paper 4's definition of duration: stability, in this series, is defined as the lock of the identity scan. The second is a *substantive theorem*,

which this paper proves and Appendix A verifies exhaustively: exactly three of the twenty-seven configurations possess a lockable core — a counting result about the geometry that is true or false independently of any definition. The third is an *empirical commitment*, stated as the falsification conditions of Section 7: the inventory of stable structure observed in nature must match the inventory of locks, standalone and junction, that the geometry permits. The definition is chosen; the theorem is proven; the commitment is risked. The Closure Principle is structured not as a circular definition but as an operational law carrying a verifiable geometric constraint: while the assignment of the word "stability" to a locked scan is an operational choice, the content of the law rests on a strict counting theorem — the three-axis framework permits exactly three of twenty-seven possible core configurations to achieve the locked condition. The three-in-twenty-seven restriction is a rigid property of the ledger, existing independently of the nomenclature. The map of the geometry forces the result, not the glossary. It *assumes* from Papers 1–4 the three-axis framework, the Per-Triangle Rule, the nine-state classification, the inside-outside structure, the two scans and their operational definitions, the conservation mechanics of the driven and stranded trajectories, and the frozen glossary. It does *not* calculate lifetimes, binding magnitudes, or the composite spectrum — Paper 16 builds the spectrum on the matrix of Paper 3 and the principle fixed here — and it does not treat motion (Paper 6) or mass accounting (Paper 8). What it provides is the stability law those papers will apply.

2. The Closure Principle Stated

Figure 1. The Lock Test: One Unambiguous Identity, or No Lock — Exactly Three of Twenty-Seven Cores Pass

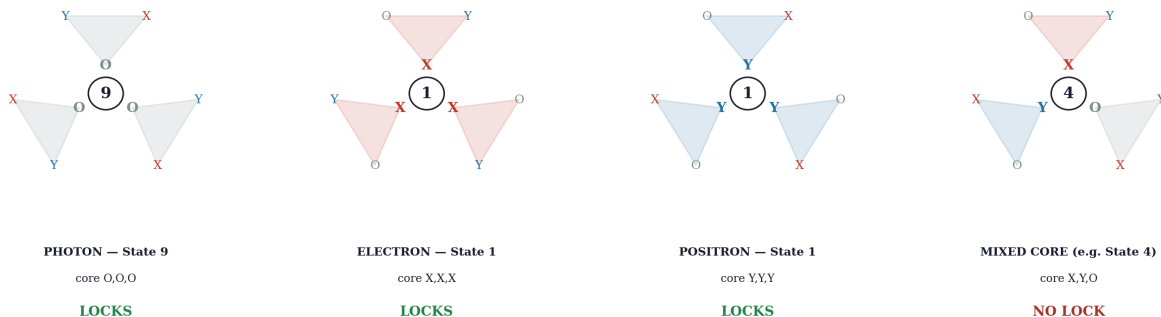


Figure 1. The lock test: a core presenting one unambiguous identity locks (the photon's pure baseline, the electron's and positron's native triplets); a mixed core gives the scan no single identity to verify and cannot lock. Exactly three of the twenty-seven cores pass.

The principle is one sentence, and the rest of the paper is its demonstration and application:

A configuration is stable if and only if its inner identity scan can lock — that is, if and only if its three center values present a single, unambiguous identity for the scan to verify on every pass, with the outer surface that the Per-Triangle Rule then forces carrying nothing unsettled.

Each clause is already grounded in the published framework, so nothing here is new machinery — only the machinery already built, assembled into a law.

The identity scan (Paper 4, Section 2; frozen in the glossary) is the inner 360-degree loop by which a configuration continuously verifies its center against its surface. It is a process, not a static logical test: it

executes, pass after pass, at the medium's own processing rate — the identity-scan rate whose visible face is *c* (Paper 4) — so "locks" and "cannot lock" are outcomes of a running operation, not timeless labels. Verification requires something verifiable: a core that returns the same answer on every executed pass. There are exactly two kinds of single-configuration core that do this. The pure baseline core — three O values — returns "baseline" on every pass; this is the photon, State 9, and its lock is the sovereign zero itself. The native triplet core — three X values or three Y values — returns one identity on every pass; this is State 1 in its two rotational directions, the electron and the positron. Every other core is mixed, and a mixed core returns different answers on successive passes: the scan reads, re-reads, and cannot lock (Paper 4, Section 3.1). A configuration whose identity scan cannot lock has no fixed orientation from which to run its temporal phase, and a configuration that must keep searching is, by the frozen definition, open — not closed, not resolved, not stable.

The surface clause follows rather than adds: by the Per-Triangle Rule the center values force the outer content, so a locked core brings its surface with it. The photon's locked baseline core forces the balanced three X, three Y surface; State 1's locked triplet forces the cleanly split surface of three of one active value and three O. Nothing on either surface reaches. The lock and the settled surface are two views of one closed condition.

So stability in this framework is not a substance a configuration contains, not a force that binds it, and not a probability assigned to it. It is the mechanical success of a scan. Closed means locked; locked means stable; and the twenty-seven-configuration ledger admits exactly three standalone closures: one photon and the two directions of State 1. The ruler's zero and first marks are not merely the anchors Paper 4 chose — they are the only standalone closures the geometry permits, which is why the ruler could be anchored nowhere else. And the count is the part no vocabulary can manufacture: call the locked condition stability, closure, or anything else, and the three-axis ledger still permits exactly three cores — out of twenty-seven — to reach it. The word is a choice; the three-in-twenty-seven is not.

3. Holding Is Not Stability: The Stranded States

Figure 2. Holding Is Not Stability: What Each Condition Presents to the Surrounding Medium

CLOSED — self-accounting

OPEN — resolution-seeking



Figure 2. What each condition presents to the surrounding medium: the closed configuration is self-accounting, soliciting no junctions; the open configuration's every sweep presents its reaching surplus to the fabric — the search is the observable signature.

The principle forces a distinction that the standard vocabulary of physics does not make cleanly, and the distinction is this paper's central clarification: *persistence is not stability*.

Paper 4 established the no-snap-back mechanics: energy is added geometry, conserved as it relocates; a configuration cannot spend what was not delivered. A configuration stranded at an open state — State 7 after a single delivered tilt, State 5 after two — cannot reverse to the photon, because reversal is a transition and transitions are paid for across interactions. The stranded state therefore *holds*. It can hold indefinitely. Nothing about it decays on its own, nothing leaks, and no spontaneous process returns it to baseline.

To maintain analytical precision, the framework enforces a strict boundary between two properties that colloquial physics frequently conflates: holding and stability. *Holding* names the conserved persistence of an open state — because energy is added geometry that cannot spontaneously reverse, a stranded intermediate configuration endures indefinitely. *Stability* is reserved strictly for closure — the mechanical success of a locked identity scan. An open state can hold as a permanent waypoint, but it never serves as a structural standard. (Where Paper 4, Section 4, described a stranded intermediate as "stable until a conserving interaction occurs," that is the property here named *holding*; the two papers describe one mechanics, and this paper fixes the vocabulary for all that follow.)

But holding is not closure. The stranded state's identity scan cannot lock its mixed core; its temporal scan sweeps the surrounding fabric, pass after pass, searching for the partner that conservation requires for any resolution. It persists as a *search*, not as a standard. The difference is exactly the difference Paper 4's metrology argument drew for the ruler: a mark must be repeatable, and an unresolved condition cannot serve as a standard however long it lasts. A waypoint that endures is still a waypoint.

And the distinction is physical, not metaphysical, because the two conditions present differently to the surrounding medium. A closed configuration runs its manifold scan as self-accounting: its core presents one settled identity, its surface presents nothing unsettled, and its sweeps audit a departure that asks nothing of its neighbors — it does not solicit junctions, because it has no deficit to fill. An open configuration's sweep is resolution-seeking: it carries an unsettled surplus on its surface and a deficit in its core, and every pass of its temporal scan presents that reaching condition to the neighboring fabric — it solicits junctions, because soliciting is what searching mechanically is. The operational signature is therefore bonding behavior itself: open states reach, link, and resolve when the fabric offers a conserving partner; closures do not seek identity change at all. An observer distinguishes the enduring waypoint from the standard not by waiting for a decay that will never come, but by what each presents at its boundary. The formal treatment of how that searching registers at macroscopic scale — to instruments (Paper 5.5) and as the resolution-seeking that gravity is (Paper 10) — is assigned forward.

This distinction dissolves a question that would otherwise look like a paradox: how can the framework call States 2 through 8 "unstable" while also insisting they cannot decay? The answer is that the framework does not call them unstable in the standard sense of "soon to fall apart." It calls them *open*: conserved, enduring, and unresolved. Stability in this series is closure — the locked scan — not mere endurance. The photon and State 1 are stable because their scans lock. The open states endure because conservation holds. The two facts are independent, and the Closure Principle is what keeps them from being confused. One further consequence of the searching states is deliberately reserved: what a rapidly searching open configuration looks like to an instrument that samples far more slowly than the medium processes — and what the standard account built on that appearance — is the subject of the companion critique, Paper 5.5.

4. The Stability Ranking of the Nine States

Figure 3. The Stability Ranking: One Criterion — What the Core Allows the Identity Scan to Do



Figure 3. The complete ranking under one criterion — what the core allows the identity scan to do: three closed, twelve leaning, six first-tilt, six undecided.

Applying the principle across the nine states produces a complete ranking, with no judgment calls and no exceptions. The criterion is single: what does the core allow the identity scan to do?

Closed (the scan locks). State 9 (core O, O, O): the pure baseline lock — zero departure, zero mass, zero duration, the sovereign zero. State 1 (core X, X, X or Y, Y, Y): the native triplet lock — the smallest resolved departure, the first marks, in the two rotational directions that give the ruler its signs.

Open with a directional lean (two center positions agree; the lock fails at one). States 2 and 3 (cores of two of one active value plus one of the other: X, X, Y and Y, Y, X) and States 5 and 6 (two of one active value plus one O: X, X, O and Y, Y, O): each core leans toward an identity without being one. Two of the three center positions already present the same value; the third dissents, and one dissenting position is enough — the scan requires a single unambiguous identity across the whole core, and a core that is two-thirds of a triplet is not a triplet (Paper 4, Section 3.1: without the full lock the unlocked value shifts, and the scan's readings vary with it). These states hold their departure and search with a committed axis — their lean is the sign their eventual resolution will carry.

Open at first departure (a baseline majority with one active intrusion). States 7 and 8 (cores X, O, O and Y, O, O): the first tilts, the states that set the axis (Paper 4, Section 4.1). Two of the three positions hold baseline O; one holds an active intrusion — the core is two-thirds of the photon's lock, and two-thirds is not a lock. These are the lightest departures that exist, and they cannot stand.

Open with full indecision (no two center positions agree). State 4 (core X, Y, O): one of each value. No two positions agree, so there is no lean, no direction, and nothing for the scan even to favor — the deepest distance from any lockable form. State 4 is the deepest case of the unlockable core, and the next section treats it in full, because its even outer surface makes it the one state where surface appearance and core condition point in opposite directions.

The ranking has one immediate consequence worth stating as a rule: *no amount of surface symmetry compensates for an unlockable core, and no core lean substitutes for a lock*. The criterion is binary at the top — locked or not — and the gradations below the line describe only how the open states search, never whether they close.

5. The Test Case: State 4 and the Symmetry Fallacy, Resolved by the Principle

Paper 4 (Section 3.1) disqualified State 4 as a ruler mark and showed the disqualification follows from the identity-scan mechanics rather than from any rule invented for the purpose. This paper restates that result as the Closure Principle's cleanest test case, because State 4 is where every alternative stability criterion fails and the principle succeeds.

The surface-balance illusion. If stability were defined by surface balance, State 4 would be misclassified as stable: its mixed core forces the only even outer surface among the open states — two X, two Y, two O, matching the counts of the baseline's non-bonding surface. A surface-based criterion declares it closed. The principle does not, because the framework never audits a configuration from the outside in; it audits from the inside out. The principle asks whether the scan can lock, and a core of one X, one Y, one O gives the scan three different answers with no majority. A balanced surface over an unlockable core is a mask, not a closure: without a full core lock the configuration has no fixed orientation from which to run its temporal phase, and it remains structurally stranded. Even surface, unlockable core — open.

The bonding misconception. That State 4 participates actively in composite bonding can look like a counter-argument for its stability, but it inverts the physics of the framework. Bonding behavior is a symptom of a core deficit, not a trophy of standalone stability. A lone State 4 cannot stand; it enters the three-way convergence and links with others *because* it is unresolved and mechanically driven to seek closure, pooling its mixed core with neighbors to complete the triplets none of them held alone and resolving back to a photon, an electron, and a positron, paid for across an interaction. The fact that it bonds is not proof of stability; it is the operational signature of its search — exactly the boundary-presentation distinction of Section 3. It persists as a waypoint, never as a self-contained standard.

The test case earns its place because it shows the principle doing analytical work, not decorating a conclusion. A criterion that ratified surface appearances would misclassify State 4; a criterion of endurance would misclassify every stranded state; the Closure Principle classifies all twenty-seven configurations correctly with one mechanical question. That is what a principle is for.

6. Closure Under Interaction: What the Principle Says About Bonds

Figure 4. Closure Under Interaction: The Joint Settles When the Exchange Completes a Core Triplet

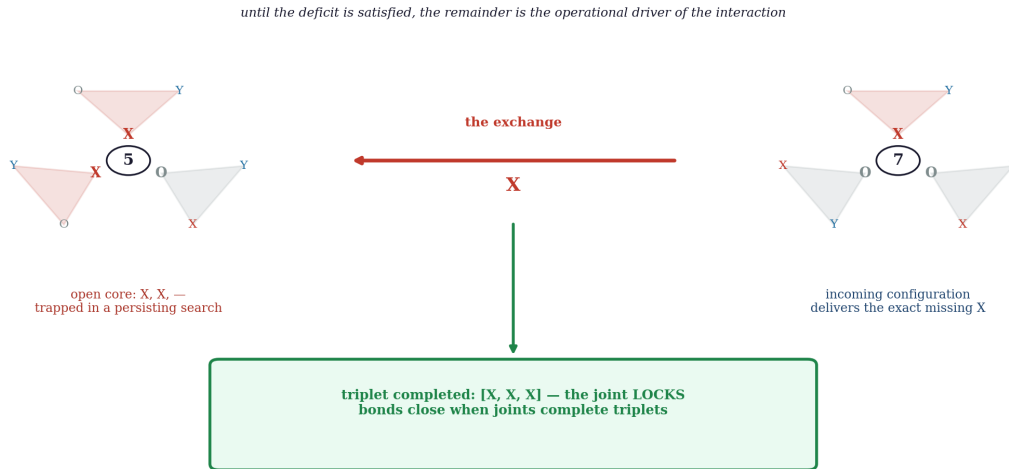


Figure 4. A joint settles if and only if the exchange completes a core triplet: the incoming configuration delivers the exact missing value, the triplet clicks shut, and the identity scan locks. Until then the remainder is the operational driver of the interaction itself.

The principle extends from standalone configurations to composite junctions without modification, and this extension is what the later papers inherit.

A bond, in the mechanics established by Papers 3 and 4, is a shared junction: configurations joined corner to corner, corner to center, or center to center, with values relocated across the interface as the exchange settles. The Closure Principle applies to the joint exactly as it applies to a core: *a composite is stable if and only if the shared junction presents the participating scans with a settled, verifiable condition on every pass.*

The mechanical condition for this lock is unyielding: a junction does not close by achieving a blended distribution or a generic surface balance. Because an identity scan can only lock onto a single, unambiguous identity, a joint settles if and only if the exchange perfectly fulfills a core triplet (3X, 3Y, or 3O) for the participating configurations.

Paper 3 (Section 8) computed which value exchanges are permitted between which open states, and Paper 4 (Section 4.2) established that the exchange is the opening of a bond. If a configuration sits with an open core — such as a center holding two X values and a dissenting third value — it is trapped in a persisting search. It cannot snap back, and it cannot close alone. The incoming configuration must deliver the exact missing value required to complete that triplet core.

Until that specific deficit is satisfied, the unaligned joint retains a remainder. This remainder is not a violation of the framework, nor is it a "semi-stable" state; it is the localized operational driver of the interaction itself, forcing the configurations to keep shifting until the triplet clicks shut. The moment the incoming value satisfies the triplet, the identity scan locks. Bonds close when joints complete triplets; a joint with a remainder is an open search exactly as a mixed core is. This paper establishes the criterion for closure; Paper 16 establishes the inventory of closures. The complete enumeration of which junction

geometries can reach the condition is therefore Paper 16's assignment, and Paper 5 does not claim to have catalogued the composites — only to have fixed the rule every composite must satisfy.

Three consequences follow for the hierarchy, each handed forward rather than developed here. First, the composite ladder of Paper 4 — three-corner bonds, the three-State-4 convergence, outside-to-inside bonding that builds heavier mass — is a ladder of closures: each rung is a different way a joint can lock a triplet, and Paper 16 builds the composite spectrum by enumerating them against Paper 3's matrix. Second, a composite can be closed even though every constituent, taken alone, would be open — closure is a property of the junction achieving a locked triplet identity, not a sum of the parts' standalone status; this is why composite matter exists at all. Third, the converse also holds and is the sharper claim: no composite is stable whose joint retains a remainder, however stable its constituents would be alone. Stability is never inherited; it is always re-earned by satisfying the triplet at the junction.

7. The Falsifiable Consequence

The principle forbids things, and stating what it forbids is what makes it science rather than description.

Forbidden: any standalone stable configuration whose core is not a pure baseline or a native triplet — equivalently, any persistent, isolated, non-searching entity corresponding to States 2 through 8 alone.

Forbidden: any stable composite whose shared junction retains an unsettled remainder. **Required:** every stable structure in nature, at every scale, decomposes into closures — locked cores and locked joints — with nothing stable left over.

Two preemptions fix the principle's scope before the falsification conditions are stated, because both will otherwise be mistaken for counterexamples. First, stability under the principle forbids *spontaneous* departure, not departure altogether: a closed state remains subject to interaction, and creation geometry can drive any configuration into transition when the energy of a collision pays for it (Paper 4, Section 6). The electron and positron meeting and converting is an interaction event, paid for at a junction — it is not a decay of either, and it no more contradicts their closure than a paid transition contradicts conservation. Second, the principle's "Required" clause is an enormous claim about the world, and the series names the debt rather than letting it float: every stable composite nature exhibits — every nucleus, every atom that persists — must, on this principle, decompose into locked cores and locked junctions. Exhibiting those junctions, structure by structure, is the assigned demonstration of Paper 16, and the assignment is itself a falsification commitment: if Paper 16's enumeration cannot supply a lockable junction for a verified stable composite, the principle fails by its own terms. The debt is named here so that no reviewer needs to name it.

One further boundary fixes what counts as *verified*, and it exposes the inference-chain shortcut by which legacy frameworks keep unverified models alive. An entity inferred solely from a missing-energy ledger, a statistical remainder, or a deficit in another framework's bookkeeping does not constitute a verified standalone entity; it is a mathematical placeholder, the accounting plug audited and rejected in Papers 2.5 and 3.5. This framework will not be falsified by another model's ghost token any more than it would be confirmed by one.

That boundary is also, precisely, the falsification condition, and it is worth stating as the demand it is. The forbidden object must be isolated and directly measured as a self-contained standard — persistent, registering its departure as mass, yet exhibiting no bonding behavior and no search at its boundary,

enduring entirely alone. The standard account already claims such objects populate the universe: stable, massive, elementary entities that neither bind nor seek interaction. It has never isolated one as a standalone standard outside the collision ledgers that infer it. The framework's position is that it cannot, because the geometry forbids it — and the framework stakes its life on exactly that point. The moment one such entity is directly isolated and verified as a standalone standard, the Closure Principle is broken and this framework ends. Until then, an unverified ledger plug carries no weight against a geometric baseline; the stake is real, and it is payable only in observation, the currency this series runs on.

The falsification condition is therefore concrete, and operational. One verified standalone stable entity with the signature of an open state breaks the principle — and the signature is specifiable in measurable terms: a persistent, isolated entity that carries departure (registers mass) yet exhibits no bonding behavior and no search, neither interacting nor reaching, enduring as a self-contained standard. In the standard account's vocabulary, a stable, isolated, massive elementary entity that neither binds nor seeks interaction would be the candidate; the framework says no such object can exist, at any scale, anywhere. So does one verified stable composite whose junction can be shown to carry a permanent remainder. The principle cannot absorb such a finding by adding a term, because it has no terms to add: it is a single binary criterion, and a counterexample does not strain it — it ends it. The series accepts that exposure deliberately, in the same spirit as Paper 3's bonding matrix and Paper 4's counting theorem: a framework with one absolute baseline can run a genuine deficit, and this principle is where Paper 5 places its stake.

8. The Principle Set, Pointing Forward

With the Closure Principle fixed, the downstream papers each apply it to a different question. Paper 6 reads rest, uniform motion, and inertia as ledger states of configurations that hold the principle's distinction between enduring and closing. Paper 8 calculates mass as the internal accounting of departure, for cores the principle has classified. Paper 10 develops gravity as resolution-seeking — the macroscopic face of the open states' searching, which this paper distinguished from stability. Paper 13 builds the time ledger on the scans whose lock-or-search alternative this paper made into law. Paper 16 enumerates the composite spectrum as the catalogue of lockable joints. Each inherits the same one-sentence law: stable means closed, closed means resolved, resolved means the scan locks.

9. Conclusion

The Closure Principle is the resolution requirement stated as law: a configuration is stable if and only if its identity scan can lock, and a composite is stable if and only if its shared junction locks. The twenty-seven-configuration ledger admits exactly three standalone closures — the photon and the two directions of State 1 — which is why the universal ruler is anchored where Paper 4 anchored it and could be anchored nowhere else. Open states endure without closing, because conservation forbids reversal while their mixed cores forbid the lock; persistence is not stability, and the difference is the difference between a waypoint and a standard. State 4's even surface over an undecidable core is the principle's cleanest test, and the principle classifies it correctly where surface criteria fail. Extended to junctions, the principle becomes the stability law of all composite matter: closure is never inherited and always re-earned. And the principle forbids enough to be broken — one standalone stable open state, one stable composite with a remaindered joint, and it falls. The papers that follow measure motion, mass, gravity, and time against the zero and the marks; this paper fixed the law that keeps the marks marks.

References

This paper is a Tier 1 foundational paper of the *Departure From the Photon Baseline* series and builds on the framework established in the companion papers below.

1. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The 27 Lagrangians of Gravity: A Survey of the Field's Standards of Evaluation* (Paper 1). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20434286>
2. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The Three-Axis Framework and the Nine-State Classification of the 27 Geometric States* (Paper 2). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20510019>
3. Kadunic, D. (2026). *They Assumed It; They Did Not See It: A Critique of Inferred Particles in Standard Physics* (Paper 2.5). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20518514>
4. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The Nine-State Classification with Inside-Outside Structure* (Paper 3). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20561941>
5. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The Constant That Does Not Stay Constant: A Structural Audit of the Fine-Structure Measurement* (Paper 3.5). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20575611>
6. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The Photon as Baseline, Electron-Positron as First Tilt* (Paper 4). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20633821>
7. Kadunic, D. (2026). *The Fragmented Metric — A Structural Deconstruction of Targeted Ruling and the Proliferation of Unfalsifiable Ontologies* (Paper 4.5). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20634735>

Paper 2 establishes the three-axis framework, the Per-Triangle Rule, and the nine-state classification. Paper 3 establishes the inside-outside structure, the bonding matrix (Section 8), and the convergence mechanics this paper restates as closures of junctions. Paper 4 establishes the two scans and their operational definitions, the counting theorem, the conservation mechanics of driven and stranded trajectories, the structural hierarchy, and the frozen glossary (Appendix B) whose terms this paper uses without modification. Paper 2.5 and Paper 3.5 establish the critique standards against which the falsifiable consequence of Section 7 is framed. The composite spectrum is the work of Paper 16; motion, mass, gravity, and time are the work of Papers 6, 8, 10, and 13 respectively; the critique of how the standard account manages the open states this paper classified is the work of the companion critique, Paper 5.5; none is pre-empted here.

A. The Lock Test Run Over All Twenty-Seven Configurations

This appendix applies the Closure Principle's single question — can the identity scan lock this core? — to every configuration of the ledger, so the principle's verdict can be verified without exception. The core column gives the three center values; the lock column gives the scan's result; the status column gives the closure verdict. The outer surface, forced by the Per-Triangle Rule, is listed for completeness and plays no role in the verdict: the principle reads the core.

#	Core (centers)	State	Scan result	Status
1	(X,X,X)	1 (electron)	locks — native triplet	CLOSED
2	(X,X,Y)	2	majority X, dissent Y — no lock	open (leaning)
3	(X,X,O)	5	majority X, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)

#	Core (centers)	State	Scan result	Status
4	(X,Y,X)	2	majority X, dissent Y — no lock	open (leaning)
5	(X,Y,Y)	3	majority Y, dissent X — no lock	open (leaning)
6	(X,Y,O)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
7	(X,O,X)	5	majority X, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)
8	(X,O,Y)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
9	(X,O,O)	7	majority O, active intrusion X — no lock	open (first tilt)
10	(Y,X,X)	2	majority X, dissent Y — no lock	open (leaning)
11	(Y,X,Y)	3	majority Y, dissent X — no lock	open (leaning)
12	(Y,X,O)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
13	(Y,Y,X)	3	majority Y, dissent X — no lock	open (leaning)
14	(Y,Y,Y)	1 (positron)	locks — native triplet	CLOSED
15	(Y,Y,O)	6	majority Y, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)
16	(Y,O,X)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
17	(Y,O,Y)	6	majority Y, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)
18	(Y,O,O)	8	majority O, active intrusion Y — no lock	open (first tilt)
19	(O,X,X)	5	majority X, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)
20	(O,X,Y)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
21	(O,X,O)	7	majority O, active intrusion X — no lock	open (first tilt)
22	(O,Y,X)	4	no majority — no lock	open (undecided)
23	(O,Y,Y)	6	majority Y, dissent O — no lock	open (leaning)
24	(O,Y,O)	8	majority O, active intrusion Y — no lock	open (first tilt)
25	(O,O,X)	7	majority O, active intrusion X — no lock	open (first tilt)
26	(O,O,Y)	8	majority O, active intrusion Y — no lock	open (first tilt)

#	Core (centers)	State	Scan result	Status
27	(O,O,O)	9 (photon)	locks — pure baseline	CLOSED

The audit closes on the count the principle predicts: exactly three closures in twenty-seven configurations — number 27 (the photon, pure baseline lock) and numbers 1 and 14 (electron and positron, native triplet locks). Twenty-four configurations are open, divided exactly as Section 4 ranks them: twelve leaning (States 2, 3, 5, 6), six undecided (State 4), and six first-tilt (States 7, 8). No configuration's verdict required any criterion beyond the single question, and no configuration falls outside the classification.

B. Glossary Cross-Reference

All terms in this paper carry the frozen definitions of Paper 4, Appendix B, without modification: identity scan, temporal scan, manifold scan, sovereign zero, resolved, open, creation geometry, energy as added geometry. This paper adds exactly two terms to the series vocabulary, defined here once: **Closure Principle** — the stability law of Section 2: a configuration is stable if and only if its identity scan can lock; a composite is stable if and only if its shared junction locks; "closed" and "resolved" name the same condition. **Lock** — the success condition of the identity scan: the core presents one unambiguous identity, verified identically on every pass. No other new terms are introduced, and these two are frozen as defined here for all subsequent papers.